

STRENGTH TRAINING

Ages 8–11

12-Week Progressive Program

LCB TRAINING

Coach Broc • Player Development Program

Program Overview

This 12-week strength program is designed specifically for athletes ages 8 to 11. The focus at this age is building foundational movement patterns, body control, balance, and athleticism using bodyweight and light-resistance exercises — not heavy lifting. Each week builds on the last. Always prioritize proper form over speed or rep count, and make sure a parent or coach is supervising each session.

Program Structure

Weeks 1–4 (Foundation): Learning basic movement patterns — squat, push, hinge, brace — and building a consistent training habit.

Weeks 5–8 (Build): Increasing reps and sets, introducing light resistance (bands or light dumbbells if available).

Weeks 9–12 (Strength): Progressing intensity and adding single-leg/single-arm variations while maintaining clean technique.

Train 2–3x per week with at least one rest day between sessions. Always complete the warm-up before strength work. Sessions should take 25–35 minutes total.

Questions About an Exercise?

Not sure how an exercise is supposed to look? Check the Exercise Glossary on the next page for a quick form reminder on every movement in this program. Still have questions? Shoot Coach Broc an email anytime, or do a quick search online for a visual reference — just make sure whatever you find matches the cue described here.

Exercise Glossary – Strength (Ages 8-11)

Quick form reminders for every exercise in this program, listed alphabetically for easy reference.

Bear Crawl: Hands and feet on the ground, knees hovering just above the floor, crawl forward keeping hips low and steady.

Bird Dog: On hands and knees, extend opposite arm and leg straight out, keep hips level and core tight.

Bodyweight Squat: Feet shoulder-width apart, chest up, sit hips back like sitting in a chair, knees track over toes.

Glute Bridge: Lie on back, knees bent, drive hips up by squeezing glutes, avoid arching the lower back.

Goblet Squat: Hold a light dumbbell at chest height, squat down keeping chest tall and elbows inside the knees.

High Knee Skips: Skip forward driving knee up to hip height each step, stay light on the toes.

High Knees: Jog in place driving knees up toward chest height, pump arms naturally.

Lateral Bound: Jump sideways off one leg, land softly on the opposite leg, stick the landing before bounding back.

Lateral Shuffle: Stay low in an athletic stance, shuffle sideways without crossing feet.

Mountain Climbers: In a push-up position, drive knees toward chest alternating quickly, keep hips level.

Plank Hold: Forearms and toes on the ground, body in a straight line from head to heels, brace the core.

Plank Reach: From a plank position, reach one arm straight forward without letting hips rotate or sag.

Push-Up: Hands under shoulders, body straight, lower chest to the ground then push back up; knees down is fine for beginners.

Reverse Lunge: Step one foot backward, lower until both knees are near 90 degrees, front knee stays over the ankle.

Side Plank: Stack feet and prop up on one forearm, lift hips so body forms a straight line, hold steady.

Single-Leg Glute Bridge: Same as Glute Bridge but one leg extended straight, drive through the heel of the grounded foot.

Walking Lunge: Step forward into a lunge, push off the back foot to step into the next lunge, alternate legs.

WEEK 1

FOUNDATION PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bodyweight Squat	3	8 reps	60 sec
Push-Up (knees ok)	3	5-8 reps	60 sec
Plank Hold	3	15-20 sec	60 sec
Glute Bridge	3	10 reps	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bear Crawl	2	20 feet	45 sec
High Knees	2	20 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Focus entirely on form this week. It's okay if reps feel easy — we're building the movement foundation.

WEEK 2

FOUNDATION PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bodyweight Squat	3	10 reps	60 sec
Push-Up (knees ok)	3	6-9 reps	60 sec
Plank Hold	3	20-25 sec	60 sec
Glute Bridge	3	12 reps	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bear Crawl	2	25 feet	45 sec
High Knees	2	25 sec	45 sec

WEEK 3 FOUNDATION PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bodyweight Squat	3	12 reps	45 sec
Push-Up (knees ok)	3	8-10 reps	45 sec
Plank Hold	3	25-30 sec	45 sec
Glute Bridge	3	14 reps	45 sec
Bird Dog	2	8 each side	45 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bear Crawl	2	30 feet	45 sec
High Knees	2	30 sec	45 sec

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Mountain Climbers	2	15 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Add Bird Dog this week to build core stability and balance.

WEEK 4 FOUNDATION PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bodyweight Squat	3	15 reps	45 sec
Push-Up (knees ok)	3	10-12 reps	45 sec
Plank Hold	3	30-35 sec	45 sec
Glute Bridge	3	15 reps	45 sec
Bird Dog	3	10 each side	45 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Bear Crawl	2	30 feet	45 sec
High Knees	2	35 sec	45 sec
Mountain Climbers	2	20 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: End of Foundation Phase! Notice how much stronger these movements feel compared to Week 1.

WEEK 5

BUILD PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Squat (light band/DB optional)	3	12 reps	60 sec
Push-Up	3	10-12 reps	60 sec
Reverse Lunge (bodyweight)	3	8 each leg	60 sec
Plank Hold	3	35-40 sec	60 sec
Glute Bridge (2-sec hold)	3	15 reps	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Shuffle	2	20 sec	45 sec
Mountain Climbers	2	25 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Introducing the Reverse Lunge — go slow and controlled, knee should not pass the toes.

WEEK 6

BUILD PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Squat (light band/DB optional)	3	14 reps	60 sec
Push-Up	3	12-14 reps	60 sec
Reverse Lunge	3	10 each leg	60 sec
Plank Hold	3	40-45 sec	60 sec
Glute Bridge (2-sec hold)	3	16 reps	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Shuffle	2	25 sec	45 sec
Mountain Climbers	2	30 sec	45 sec

WEEK 7 BUILD PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Squat (light band/DB optional)	4	12 reps	60 sec
Push-Up	3	14-16 reps	60 sec
Reverse Lunge	3	10 each leg	60 sec
Side Plank	3	15-20 sec each side	45 sec
Glute Bridge (single-leg)	3	8 each leg	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Shuffle	2	30 sec	45 sec

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Skater Jumps	2	10 each side	45 sec

Coach's Note: Single-leg Glute Bridge challenges balance — take it slow and controlled.

WEEK 8 BUILD PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Squat (light band/DB optional)	4	14 reps	60 sec
Push-Up	3	16-18 reps	60 sec
Reverse Lunge	3	12 each leg	60 sec
Side Plank	3	20-25 sec each side	45 sec
Glute Bridge (single-leg)	3	10 each leg	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Shuffle	2	30 sec	45 sec
Skater Jumps	2	12 each side	45 sec

Coach's Note: End of Build Phase! Strength, balance, and core control should all feel noticeably better.

WEEK 9

STRENGTH PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Goblet Squat (light DB)	4	12 reps	60 sec
Push-Up (feet elevated optional)	4	12-15 reps	60 sec
Walking Lunge	3	10 each leg	60 sec
Plank Reach	3	8 each arm	45 sec
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3	10 each leg	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Bound	3	8 each side	45 sec
High Knee Skips	2	20 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Goblet Squat introduces light external load — use a light dumbbell or medicine ball.

WEEK 10

STRENGTH PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Goblet Squat	4	14 reps	60 sec
Push-Up (feet elevated optional)	4	15-18 reps	60 sec
Walking Lunge	3	12 each leg	60 sec
Plank Reach	3	10 each arm	45 sec
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3	12 each leg	60 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Bound	3	10 each side	45 sec
High Knee Skips	2	25 sec	45 sec

WEEK 11

STRENGTH PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Goblet Squat	4	15 reps	45 sec
Push-Up (feet elevated optional)	4	18-20 reps	45 sec
Walking Lunge	3	14 each leg	45 sec
Plank Reach	3	12 each arm	45 sec
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3	14 each leg	45 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Bound	3	12 each side	45 sec

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
High Knee Skips	3	25 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Almost there! Push intensity slightly this week while keeping form sharp.

WEEK 12 STRENGTH PHASE

Warm-Up

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Jumping Jacks	1	30 sec	—
Arm Circles	1	10 each way	—
Bodyweight Squats	1	10 reps	—

Strength Work

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Goblet Squat	4	15 reps	45 sec
Push-Up (feet elevated)	4	20 reps	45 sec
Walking Lunge	4	15 each leg	45 sec
Plank Reach	4	12 each arm	45 sec
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	4	15 each leg	45 sec

Conditioning Finisher

Exercise	Sets	Reps / Time	Rest
Lateral Bound	3	15 each side	45 sec
High Knee Skips	3	30 sec	45 sec

Coach's Note: Program complete! Compare these numbers to Week 1 — that's real, measurable progress. Time to check in with Coach Broc about your next program.